



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Periodic Test (Pt) — 40 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 8 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Sangam literature, the earliest Tamil literary tradition, dates between which period? (A) 600 BCE and 300 BCE (B) 300 CE and 600 CE (C) 300 BCE and 300 CE (D) 500 BCE and 500 CE Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Sangam literature, the earliest Tamil literary tradition, dates between 300 BCE and 300 CE, and much of what we know about the early Tamil kingdoms comes from it. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
2	What is the blanket of air surrounding the Earth called? (A) Hydrosphere (B) Lithosphere (C) Atmosphere (D) Biosphere Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The atmosphere is the blanket of air surrounding the Earth, pulled down by gravity, and is a mixture of gases vital for the survival of all living beings. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	According to the Law of Supply, what happens to the quantity supplied as price rises? (A) Quantity supplied increases (B) Quantity supplied decreases (C) Quantity supplied remains unchanged (D) Quantity supplied becomes zero Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Quantity supplied increases, because the Law of Supply shows a direct relationship — as price rises, quantity supplied increases. [Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]	1
4	Magadha, which gradually emerged as the most powerful mahājanapada, was located in present-day which state? (A) Bihar (B) Uttar Pradesh (C) West Bengal (D) Jharkhand Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Magadha, located in present-day Bihar, gradually emerged as the most powerful among the sixteen mahājanapadas due to its strategic location, fertile plains, and strong rulers. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
5	The Governor of a State nominates some members to the Vidhan Parishad to represent certain fields. Which of the following fields is among those for which members are nominated? (A) Agriculture and irrigation (B) Commerce and industry (C) Sports and entertainment (D) Art, science, social service, literature, and co-operatives Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Governor of the State nominates some members to the Vidhan Parishad to represent fields such as art, science, social service, literature, and co-operatives. [Ch 7: Elections]	1
6	According to the principle of Rule of Law, which of the following is true? (A) Laws apply differently based on social status (B) Disputes are resolved by force or personal influence (C) Citizens can be punished without due process in emergencies (D) No one is above the law and everyone is equal before it Answer: Correct Option: (D)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? D. The Rule of Law ensures equality before the law and equal protection of the law, and establishes that no one is above the law. [Ch 6: Democracy]	
7	The Sumerian writing system known as cuneiform was created using what tool and material? (A) A sharp iron stylus pressed onto papyrus sheets (B) A feather quill dipped in ink on parchment (C) A stone chisel carved into rock surfaces (D) A wedge-shaped stylus pressed into soft clay tablets Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Cuneiform was written by pressing a wedge-shaped stylus into soft clay tablets. The word cuneiform comes from the Latin word <i>cuneus</i>, meaning 'wedge'. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
8	Why are glaciers crucial for human populations living downstream? (A) They are crucial sources of fresh water, feeding rivers that sustain populations downstream (B) They provide cool air for agriculture (C) They create barriers against invasions (D) They generate hydroelectric power directly from glacial ice Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Glaciers are crucial sources of fresh water, feeding rivers that sustain human populations downstream. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
Section B Attempt all 4 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
9	How did the warming of Earth's climate around 12000 years ago affect human life during the Mesolithic period? Answer: Earth's climate became warmer, causing forests and grasslands to expand into previously ice-covered areas. This offered a wider variety of resources including small game animals, fish, and edible wild grains, leading to the first-ever population explosion. Microlithic tools enabled gathering of aquatic food, and fishing became the mainstay. ► Why? This tests the cause-and-effect relationship between climate change and the Mesolithic lifestyle, including population growth and new subsistence strategies. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	2
10	How does Geography integrate spatial and temporal perspectives in its study?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Geography adopts a holistic approach by integrating spatial perspectives, which focus on location and its significance, with temporal perspectives, which focus on change over time. It views the world as a system of interdependencies. ► Why? The source explicitly states that Geography combines spatial and temporal perspectives to provide a holistic understanding of the world as interdependent systems. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
11	What is market equilibrium? What happens to prices at this point? Answer: Market equilibrium is the point where the quantity demanded equals the quantity supplied. At this point, there is no pressure for prices to change, and the market is 'cleared', meaning there is neither a shortage (excess demand) nor a surplus (excess supply). ► Why? Equilibrium represents the balance point where demand and supply forces are equal, resulting in price stability. [Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]	2
12	What role does the government play in a market economy, and who owns the resources? Answer: In a market economy, the government acts like a referee in a football match—it ensures safety and law and order without controlling prices or production. The ownership of factories, shops, land, and other resources largely rests with individuals and private companies. Examples include the United States of America, Japan, and Hong Kong. ► Why? This tests understanding of the government's limited role and private ownership structure in a market economy. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	2
Section C Attempt 3 out of 4.		
13	How do the cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts differ from the Harappan script in terms of their historical significance? Answer: The cuneiform script of the Sumerians in Mesopotamia and the hieroglyphic script of ancient Egypt both flourished around the same time as the Harappan Civilisation, roughly 5000 years ago. Unlike the Harappan script, which remains undeciphered, these two scripts have been deciphered. Because they can now be read and understood, they mark the beginning of the historical period. The Harappan script, despite being one of the earliest known writing systems, cannot serve this purpose since it has not been deciphered. Thus, while all three scripts are early writing systems, only cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts provide textual evidence that transitions prehistory into history.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer contrasts the deciphered cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts with the undeciphered Harappan script in terms of their role in marking the historical period. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the cuneiform and hieroglyphic scripts and their approximate age. 2. Step 2: Contrast their deciphered status with the undeciphered Harappan script. 3. Step 3: Explain how deciphered scripts mark the beginning of the historical period. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
	OR What are deltas, and why are they significant for agriculture, fishing, and human settlements? Answer: A delta is a landform formed at the mouth of a river, where it flows into a sea, ocean, or lake, and deposits sediments carried from upstream. Over time, these deposits accumulate to form a fan-shaped or triangular area of land. Deltas are highly fertile due to their rich alluvial soil, making them ideal for agriculture and supporting crops such as rice and jute. They are important for fishing, as the mix of fresh and saltwater creates diverse aquatic life. Many deltas support dense human settlements and are centres of trade and transportation because rivers provide navigable routes. However, they can also be prone to flooding, which affects human life and activities. ► Why? The answer covers delta formation at river mouths and their multi-faceted significance for agriculture, fishing, settlements, and trade, while also noting the risk of flooding. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define a delta and explain how sediments accumulate at the river mouth. 2. Step 2: Describe the agricultural and fishing significance of deltas. 3. Step 3: Mention settlements, trade, transportation, and the risk of flooding. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
14	Explain the transition from janapadas to mahājanapadas and the factors that drove this political evolution. Answer: The term janapada literally means where a people (jana) first set its feet, indicating a transition from kinship-based identity to territorial identity between approximately 1000 BCE and 600 BCE. People were now connected not only by kinship ties but also by a sense of belonging to a land. Control over land, agricultural production, and trade routes became increasingly important, leading to more complex administrative systems. As a result, from approximately 600 BCE to 300 CE, new political formations called mahājanapadas—bigger political units than janapadas—arose. Historical sources usually speak of sixteen mahājanapadas, with Magadha gradually emerging as the most powerful. ► Why? The answer traces the political evolution from kinship-based janapadas to territorial mahājanapadas, identifying the key factors of land control, agriculture, and trade. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define janapada and explain the shift from kinship to territorial identity. 2. Step 2: Identify the factors driving this transition—land, agriculture, and trade. 3. Step 3: Explain the emergence of mahājanapadas and mention the sixteen mahājanapadas. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
15	Explain the concept of opportunity cost using the example of crop production decisions. How does it reflect a trade-off between short-term gains and long-term sustainability? Answer: The question of what to produce involves choosing which goods and services to produce and in what quantities. For instance, farmers must decide whether to produce water-intensive crops such as sugarcane and paddy, or drought-resistant crops such as millets and pulses. Producing sugarcane yields high profits and supports industries such as sugar, representing short-term economic gains. However, producing millets and pulses saves water, improves soil health, and promotes sustainable agriculture. The opportunity cost of producing sugarcane is the forgone gains from saved water and improved soil health. This decision reflects a trade-off between short-term economic gains and long-term sustainability, as producers must account for the opportunity costs of various alternatives. ► Why? The answer uses the crop example from the source to explain opportunity cost as the forgone benefit of the next best alternative, and connects it to the trade-off between short-term profit and long-term sustainability. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Explain the decision between water-intensive crops (sugarcane, paddy) and drought-resistant crops (millets, pulses) 2. Step 2: Define opportunity cost as the forgone gains from saved water and improved soil health when choosing sugarcane 3. Step 3: Conclude by explaining how this reflects a trade-off between short-term gains and long-term sustainability [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	3
Section D Attempt 2 out of 3.		
16	Explain the structure of the Earth's interior and describe how the movement of tectonic plates shapes the Earth's surface. Include the different types of plate boundaries and their associated landforms in your answer.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The Earth is composed of three main layers: the crust, mantle, and core. The crust is the outermost layer, while the mantle beneath it is thick and hot. The innermost core is extremely hot and heavy. The crust and the upper part of the mantle form the lithosphere, which is broken into massive solid rock slabs called tectonic plates. These plates are of three types: continental, oceanic, and mixed. Beneath the lithosphere lies the semi-molten asthenosphere. Heat from the Earth's core causes molten material in the mantle to rise and cooler material to sink, creating convection currents that push and pull the tectonic plates. The movement of these plates shapes the Earth's surface at plate boundaries. At convergent boundaries, plates move towards each other. When continental plates collide, they form fold mountains like the Himalaya. When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate, the oceanic plate sinks, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. At divergent boundaries, plates move away from each other, allowing magma to rise and form new crust, creating features like mid-ocean ridges, such as the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. At transform boundaries, plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust, mainly causing earthquakes, such as along the San Andreas Fault. Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along these boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. ► Why? <i>The Earth's internal structure drives plate tectonics through convection currents, and the interactions at plate boundaries create major landforms and natural disasters.</i> ► Step-by-step: <i>Step 1: Introduce the Earth's three main layers and the formation of the lithosphere and asthenosphere.</i> <i>Step 2: Explain the role of convection currents in the mantle causing the movement of tectonic plates.</i> <i>Step 3: Describe the three types of plate boundaries: convergent, divergent, and transform.</i> <i>Step 4: Provide examples of landforms and events associated with each boundary type (e.g., Himalaya, Mid-Atlantic Ridge, San Andreas Fault).</i> <i>Step 5: Conclude with the significance of plate boundaries in the distribution of earthquakes and volcanoes, mentioning the Ring of Fire.</i> <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	
	OR Describe the composition of the atmosphere and explain how the atmosphere regulates conditions on Earth, influencing weather and climate. Support your answer with relevant examples from the elements of weather discussed.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The Earth's atmosphere is a blanket of air surrounding the Earth, pulled down by gravity. It is composed of a mixture of various gases. Nitrogen and oxygen are the two primary and most abundant gases, essential to life on Earth. Other gases present in lesser quantities include carbon dioxide, argon, helium, neon, krypton, xenon, ozone, and hydrogen. Besides gases, the atmosphere also contains water vapour, generally ranging from 0.1 per cent to 0.4 per cent, and tiny dust particles. Water vapour plays a significant role in cloud formation and precipitation. The composition of the atmosphere also varies with altitude. The atmosphere shields us from harmful radiation coming from the Sun, including ultraviolet radiation. It regulates the Earth's temperature by trapping some of the Sun's energy and preventing it from escaping back into space. It is a key component of the Earth's weather and climate systems, influencing factors such as temperature, humidity, and air pressure. Temperature varies between day and night and across seasons. An important factor affecting temperature distribution is insolation, which decreases from the equator towards the poles, causing temperature to decrease in the same direction. Humidity refers to the presence of water vapour in the air. As air gets warmer, its capacity to hold water vapour increases, leading to higher humidity. Precipitation occurs when the atmosphere becomes saturated with water vapour, which condenses and falls due to gravity in forms such as drizzle, rain, snow, sleet, and hail. Rain is the most common form and lowers the temperature of a place. Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface; it is highest at sea level and decreases with altitude. In areas with high temperatures, air heats up and rises, creating low pressure associated with cloudy skies and wet weather. In areas with lower temperatures, cold air sinks, creating high pressure associated with clear and sunny skies. Wind, the movement of air from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, further shapes weather conditions. ► Why? <i>The atmosphere's gas composition and its role in regulating temperature, radiation, and weather elements such as humidity, precipitation, and pressure are all interconnected systems that sustain life and shape climate.</i> ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: <i>Introduce the atmosphere as a blanket of air pulled down by gravity and describe its gas composition including nitrogen, oxygen, and other trace gases, water vapour, and dust particles.</i> 2. Step 2: <i>Explain how the atmosphere shields Earth from harmful radiation and regulates temperature by trapping the Sun's energy.</i> 3. Step 3: <i>Discuss the elements of weather — temperature (insolation), humidity, precipitation, and atmospheric pressure — and how each is influenced by the atmosphere.</i> 4. Step 4: <i>Explain the relationship between temperature, pressure, and wind, including how high and low pressure areas form and their associated weather.</i> 5. Step 5: <i>Conclude by summarising how all these elements together constitute the Earth's weather and climate systems.</i> <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
17	Discuss the various sources used by historians to understand the social realities of the past. How do different historical traditions, including the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and modern historiography, contribute to the study of history? Answer: History is the study of the human past, helping societies understand people's experiences, values, and changes over time. Different historical traditions have used various methods to preserve cultural memory. In Bharat, the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition shares historical information through stories, giving cultural meaning to events and reinforcing enduring ideals and values. In contrast, modern historiography increasingly relies on empirical evidence and scientific tools like human genetics, carbon-14 dating, and archaeology to establish timelines. To understand social realities, historians draw on a wide range of sources. Literary sources include travelogues, memoirs, correspondence, genealogical records, folklore, and oral traditions. Archaeological sources consist of material remains such as monuments, architectural structures, excavated sites, artefacts, and art like sculptures and paintings, which often require scientific instruments and laboratory testing for analysis. Additionally, epigraphic sources provide direct evidence through texts, decrees, or records inscribed on durable materials like stone, metal plates, or rock surfaces, revealing information about past events, rulers, and administration. Numismatic sources, comprising coins, currency, or medals, help historians study the economy, chronology, trade, and political boundaries through the metal content, inscriptions, and symbols on coins. By combining these diverse traditions and sources, history not only documents what happened but also transmits cultural values from one generation to the next. ► Why? The answer explains the diverse methods and sources—literary, archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic—used in history writing, contrasting traditional storytelling with modern empirical methods. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce history as the study of the human past and the need to understand social realities. 2. Step 2: Contrast the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition's storytelling approach with modern historiography's reliance on empirical evidence and scientific tools. 3. Step 3: Detail the literary sources such as travelogues, memoirs, and oral traditions. 4. Step 4: Explain archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic sources, providing specific examples of each from the material. 5. Step 5: Conclude by summarizing how these combined sources help transmit cultural values and establish timelines. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	5
Section E Attempt 1 out of 1.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
18	Case Study: Indian Knowledge Traditions and Interconnectedness Early human communities depended directly on nature for survival, gradually learning to grow crops and build settlements. This spirit of inquiry has deep roots in India's knowledge traditions. The concept of the Pañchamahābhūtas describes the natural world as an interconnected system in which human life is embedded. Similarly, the idea of vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam expresses the interconnectedness of human societies. Early reflections on governance also linked political authority with public welfare; the Arthaśhāstra, attributed to Kauṭilya about 2,300 years ago, examined administration and economic management. Modern Social Science continues this legacy, recognizing that a single event, like a drought, affects crops, incomes, government relief, migration, and culture. (i) What does the concept of the Pañchamahābhūtas describe? (ii) How does the idea of vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam express the interconnectedness of human societies? (iii) Explain how a single event like a drought demonstrates the need for multiple disciplines in Social Science. (iv) What aspects of governance and economy were examined in the Arthaśhāstra attributed to Kauṭilya? Answer: (i) The Pañchamahābhūtas describes the natural world as an interconnected system in which human life is embedded. (ii) Vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam means 'the world is one family' and expresses the interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures. (iii) A drought affects crops (environment), farmers' incomes (economy), government relief measures (politics), migration to cities (society), and traditional ways of coping with scarcity (culture). This shows that no single field can fully explain the situation, requiring multiple disciplines to understand it comprehensively. (iv) The Arthaśhāstra examined administration, economic management, taxation, and the duties of rulers toward their people. ► Why? i) The Pañchamahābhūtas describes the natural world as an interconnected system in which human life is embedded. ii) Vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam means 'the world is one family' and expresses the interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures. iii) A drought affects crops (environment), farmers' incomes (economy), government relief measures (politics), migration to cities (society), and traditional ways of coping with scarcity (culture). This shows that no single field can fully explain the situation, requiring multiple disciplines to understand it comprehensively. iv) The Arthaśhāstra examined administration, economic management, taxation, and the duties of rulers toward their people. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	5

